

First Terminal Examination - 2079

Class : XI

Subject: C. English (0031)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET B

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

Attempt all the questions.

1. Read the text and do the tasks.

(15)

Alas, even if wars remain an unprofitable business in the twenty-first century, that would not give us an absolute guarantee of peace. We should never underestimate human stupidity. Both on the personal and on the collective level, humans are prone to engage in self-destructive activities.

In 1939, war was probably a counterproductive move for the Axis powers – yet it did not save the world. One of the astounding things about the Second World War is that following the war the defeated powers prospered as never before. Twenty years after the complete annihilation of their armies and the utter collapse of their empires, Germans, Italians and Japanese were enjoying unprecedented levels of affluence. Why, then, did they go to war in the first place? Why did they inflict unnecessary death and destruction on countless millions? It was all just a stupid miscalculation. In the 1930s Japanese generals, admirals, economists and journalists concurred that without control of Korea, Manchuria and the Chinese coast, Japan was doomed to economic stagnation. They were all wrong. In fact, the famed Japanese economic miracle began only after Japan lost all its mainland conquests.

Human stupidity is one of the most important forces in history, yet we often discount it. Politicians, generals and scholars treat the world as a great chess game, where every move follows careful rational calculations. This is correct up to a point. Few leaders in history have been mad in the narrow sense of the word, moving pawns and knights at random. General Tojo, Saddam Hussein and Kim Jong-il had rational reasons for every move they played. The problem is that the world is far more complicated than a chessboard, and human rationality is not up to the task of really understanding it. Hence even rational leaders frequently end up doing very stupid things.

So how much should we fear a world war? It is best to avoid two extremes. On the one hand, war is definitely not inevitable. The peaceful termination of the Cold War proves that when humans make the right decisions, even superpower conflicts can be resolved

peacefully. Moreover, it is exceedingly dangerous to assume that a new world war is inevitable. That would be a self-fulfilling prophecy. Once countries assume that war is inevitable, they beef up their armies, embark on spiraling arms races, refuse to compromise in any conflict, and suspect that goodwill gestures are just traps. That guarantees the eruption of war.

On the other hand, it would be naïve to assume that war is impossible. Even if war is catastrophic for everyone, no god and no law of nature protects us from human stupidity.

One potential remedy for human stupidity is a dose of humility. National, religious and cultural tensions are made worse by the grandiose feeling that my nation, my religion and my culture are the most important in the world – hence my interests should come before the interests of anyone else, or of humankind as a whole. How can we make nations, religions and cultures a bit more realistic and modest about their true place in the world?

A. Tick the correct answer. (5×1=5)

- i. The word “**counterproductive**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
 - a. ineffective
 - b. feasible
 - c. profitable
 - d. useful
- ii. The word “**annihilation**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
 - a. restoration
 - b. complete destruction
 - c. construction
 - d. protection
- iii. The word “**beef up**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
 - a. to make something stronger
 - b. to feed beef to armies
 - c. to put beef up
 - d. to make something important
- iv. The word “**affluence**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
 - a. the state of winning many things
 - b. the state of owning many things
 - c. the state of losing many things
 - d. the state of being fluent
- v. The word “**catastrophic**” in the passage is closest in meaning to
 - a. disastrous
 - b. heartening
 - c. encouraging
 - d. fortuitous

B. Write True, False or Not Given. (5×1=5)

- a. Human stupidity shouldn't be underestimated.
- b. Japanese economic miracle began after it lost all its mainland conquests.

- c. Politicians, generals and scholars treat the world as a great chess game.
- d. Leaders end up doing stupid things as their lives are very complicated.
- e. Dose of humility is the only remedy for human stupidity.

C. Fill in the blanks NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS. (5×1=5)

- a. Humans often discount
- b. Right decisions can resolve
- c. Assuming that a new world war is inevitable would be
- d. It would be naïve to assume that war is
- e. No god and no law of nature protects us from

2. Write short answers to the following questions. (5×2=10)

- a. What is the main theme of the story *The Selfish Giant*?
- b. To which two things does the speaker compare his love in the first stanza? (*A Red, Red Rose*)
- c. What is the difference between oral tradition and literary tradition? (*Sharing Tradition*)
- d. What does the speaker mean when he says:
But have you every counted
How man have died so far
Because of you and your wars? (*Corona Says*)
- e. Which image in the poem do you find the most memorable or surprising and why? (*A Red, Red Rose*)

3. Write long answers to the following questions. (2×5=10)

- a. “Not everyone is capable of fulfilling the roles of the elders.” Explain this statement with reference to the essay *Sharing Tradition*.
- b. Does God punish those who are cruel to children and very selfish? (*The Selfish Giant*)

4. Write a paragraph describing the most memorable recent journey you have had. Word limit: 150 (7)

5. Write a letter to your friend telling him/her about your expectation from the college you are currently attending. Word limit: 180 (8)

6. In recent years, online education is becoming more and more popular. What are the advantages and disadvantages of this phenomenon? Use specific details and examples to explain your opinion. Word limit: 250-300 (10)

7. Rewrite the following sentences as instructed. (10×1=10)

- a. I look forward to hearing from you very soon. (*Underline the preposition in the sentence.*)
- b. Everyone (is/are) happy in the nation. (*Choose the correct verb from the brackets to complete the sentence.*)
- c. Measles (has/have) killed thousands of people. (*Choose the correct verb from the brackets to complete the sentence.*)
- d. Look! It (be/rain). (*Choose the correct verb from the brackets to complete the sentence.*)
- e. We are going to stay there for ten days. (*Identify the word class of the underlined word.*)
- f. This stone is extremely hard. (*Underline the adjective in the sentence.*)
- g. The man has never crossed the line. (*Underline the adverb in the sentence.*)
- h. She beautifully dances. (*Place the underlined word in the right position.*)
- i. He is fond dancing. (*Fill in the blank with the appropriate preposition.*)
- j. They are not interested dancing. (*Fill in the blank with the appropriate preposition.*)

8. Do as instructed. (5×1=5)

- a. **taxi** /'tæksi/ noun, verb
noun 1 (also **cab, taxi-cab**) a car with a driver that you pay to take you somewhere. Taxis usually have METERS which show how much money you have to pay: a **taxi driver/ride** -*We'd better take a taxi.* - *I came home by taxi.* - to **order/hail/call a taxi** **2** in some places in Africa, small bus with a driver that you pay to take you somewhere. Taxis usually have fixed routes and stop wherever passengers need to get on or off.
verb (taxi-ing, tax-ied, tax-ied) [V] (of a plane) to move slowly along the ground before taking off or after landing
What is the headword in the given dictionary entry?
- b. Arrange the following words in alphabetical order.
tautology tawdry taunt taut
- c. What does the sentence '*I noticed that the cat was looking a little under the weather.*' mean?
 - i. The cat was not completely well.
 - ii. The cat was enjoying the sun.
- d. Write the present participle and the past participle of the verb '**forgive**'.
- e. Make two words by using the suffix '**-ion**'.